

Prompt Library Starter Kit

30 tested prompts you can use today — organized by what you actually do

These aren't generic prompts. Each one is built with the principles from *Creating with Claude*: they give context, they're specific about what you want, and they tell Claude exactly how to deliver. Copy them, customize the brackets, and make them yours.

How to use this library: Find the category that matches your work. Pick a prompt. Replace everything in [brackets] with your specifics. Then iterate — Claude's first answer is a starting point, not the finish line.

Writing & Communication

The Email Drafter

Write a [professional/casual] email to [audience] about [topic]. The goal is to [what you want them to do]. Keep it under [X] sentences. Tone: [direct/warm/formal]. Don't use [words or phrases to avoid].

Why it works: Specificity about tone, length, and audience gets you a draft you barely need to edit.

The Document Outliner

I need to write a [type of document] about [topic] for [audience]. Before writing anything, give me a structured outline with main sections and 2-3 key points per section. The document should be approximately [length]. My main argument is [thesis].

Why it works: Outlining first prevents the 'beautiful wall of text that misses the point' problem.

The Tone Shifter

Here's a draft I wrote: [paste text]. Rewrite it for [new audience] while keeping the core message. Make it [more formal / more casual / shorter / more persuasive]. Keep my key points but adjust the language.

Why it works: Better than starting from scratch — you keep your ideas but get the right packaging.

The Blog Post Builder

Write a blog post about [topic] for [target reader]. They care about this because [why it matters to them]. Include a hook that opens with [a question / a surprising fact /

a story]. Length: [X] words. End with [a call to action / a question / key takeaway].

Why it works: Naming the reader and their motivation produces content that actually connects.

The Meeting Summary

Here are my raw notes from a meeting: [paste notes]. Turn these into a clean summary with: 1) Key decisions made, 2) Action items with owners and deadlines, 3) Open questions. Keep it under one page.

Why it works: The structured output means you can send this directly — no reformatting needed.

Research & Analysis

The Research Brief

Research [topic] and give me a briefing document I can act on. Include: current state of the field, 3-5 key findings, areas of disagreement among experts, and what this means for [my specific situation]. Cite your sources. Flag anything you're uncertain about.

Why it works: Asking Claude to flag uncertainty prevents the most dangerous hallucinations.

The Competitor Analysis

Compare [Company/Product A] vs [Company/Product B] for someone who needs [specific use case]. Compare on: [criteria 1], [criteria 2], [criteria 3]. Present as a table, then give me your recommendation with reasoning. Note anything I should verify independently.

Why it works: Structured comparison + verification flag = analysis you can trust.

The Decision Framework

I need to decide between [Option A] and [Option B]. Context: [your situation]. My priorities are [what matters most]. Give me a structured comparison: pros/cons of each, risks I might not be seeing, and what questions I should ask before deciding. Don't make the decision for me.

Why it works: The 'don't decide for me' instruction gets you honest analysis instead of validation.

The Data Interpreter

Here's some data: [paste data or describe it]. Tell me: What are the 3 most important patterns? What's surprising or counterintuitive? What would you want to investigate

further? Present findings as insights, not just descriptions of the data.

Why it works: Pushing for insights instead of descriptions gets you actionable analysis.

The Policy Summarizer

Summarize this policy/regulation/document: [paste or describe]. Tell me: What does this actually require me to do? What are the deadlines? What are the penalties for non-compliance? Give me the plain-English version a non-lawyer can act on.

Why it works: The 'plain English' and 'what do I actually do' framing cuts through legalese.

Teaching & Training

The Lesson Plan Builder

Create a [length] lesson plan for [grade/level] on [topic]. Include: learning objectives, an engaging opener, main activity, discussion questions, and an assessment. Students already know [prior knowledge]. The lesson should work for [class size] students.

Why it works: Prior knowledge context prevents lessons that are too basic or too advanced.

The Explainer

Explain [complex topic] to someone who [level of knowledge]. Use an analogy from [their world/field]. Avoid jargon. If you must use a technical term, define it immediately. Keep it under [length].

Why it works: The analogy + jargon rules force clarity that's actually useful.

The Quiz Maker

Create a [X]-question [quiz type] on [topic] for [audience]. Include a mix of difficulty: [X] easy recall, [X] application, [X] analysis. Provide an answer key with brief explanations for why each answer is correct.

Why it works: Specifying difficulty distribution prevents all-easy or all-hard quizzes.

The Study Guide

Create a study guide for [topic/exam]. Organize by concept, not chronologically. For each concept: one-sentence definition, one real-world example, one common mistake students make, one practice question. Keep explanations at [level].

Why it works: The 'common mistake' element makes this dramatically more useful than a standard summary.

The Feedback Writer

I need to give feedback on this [student work / employee performance / draft]: [paste or describe]. Be specific and constructive. Structure: what's working well (with examples), what needs improvement (with specific suggestions), and one priority to focus on next.

Why it works: The structure prevents vague feedback and the 'one priority' creates actionable next steps.

Business & Strategy

The Proposal Builder

Write a [proposal type] for [client/audience]. The problem: [what they're struggling with]. My solution: [what I'm offering]. Key benefits for them: [specifics]. Budget: [range]. Timeline: [estimate]. Tone: [confident but not pushy]. Length: [X] pages.

Why it works: Leading with their problem instead of your solution gets proposals that actually land.

The SWOT Analysis

Run a SWOT analysis on [business/product/idea]. Context: I'm a [role] in [industry] considering [specific decision]. Be brutally honest about weaknesses and threats – I need reality, not cheerleading. For each point, explain WHY it matters, not just what it is.

Why it works: The 'brutally honest' instruction overrides Claude's tendency to be encouraging.

The Process Documenter

I'm going to describe a process we follow at work. Document it as a clear, step-by-step procedure that a new hire could follow. Include: numbered steps, who's responsible for each, common pitfalls, and what 'done' looks like at each stage. Here's the process: [describe it].

Why it works: The 'new hire could follow' standard forces the right level of detail.

The Elevator Pitch

Help me explain [my business/project/idea] in 30 seconds to [specific audience]. They care about [their priorities]. I need them to [desired action]. Give me 3 versions: one that leads with the problem, one that leads with the result, one that leads with a story.

Why it works: Three versions from different angles beats one 'perfect' pitch every time.

The Budget Planner

Help me create a budget for [project/event/quarter]. Known costs: [list what you know]. Categories to include: [list them]. Flag any costs I'm probably forgetting. Present as a table with line items, estimated costs, and a contingency row at 10-15%.

Why it works: The 'costs I'm probably forgetting' instruction is where Claude adds the most value.

Creative & Personal

The Brainstorm Partner

I'm stuck on [problem/creative challenge]. Here's what I've already considered: [your ideas]. Give me 10 ideas I haven't thought of – including at least 3 that are unconventional or counterintuitive. Don't censor yourself. Then tell me which 2-3 you'd actually pursue and why.

Why it works: Sharing your existing ideas prevents Claude from restating the obvious.

The Content Calendar

Create a [X]-week content calendar for [platform] about [topic/niche]. My audience is [who]. Post frequency: [X per week]. For each post: the hook (first line), content type (story/tip/question/list), and a one-line content brief. Mix formats to prevent fatigue.

Why it works: Specifying the hook format prevents generic 'Did you know...' content.

The Gift Idea Generator

I need a gift for [person and relationship]. They're interested in [interests]. Budget: [range]. They already have [things to avoid]. Give me 5 ideas: 2 safe bets, 2 creative surprises, and 1 experience rather than a thing.

Why it works: The category structure prevents a generic list and forces genuine variety.

The Cover Letter Crafter

Write a cover letter for [job title] at [company]. My relevant experience: [2-3 key qualifications]. What excites me about this role: [genuine reason]. My differentiator: [what makes me different]. Tone: [confident but genuine, not desperate]. One page max.

Why it works: The differentiator question forces specificity that generic cover letters lack.

The Weekend Planner

Plan a [type: relaxing/adventure/family/productive] weekend for [who's involved]. Location: [where]. Budget: [range]. Must include: [any requirements]. Avoid: [things you don't want]. Give me a rough timeline, not just a list of ideas.

Why it works: A timeline with transitions is dramatically more useful than a suggestion list.

Meta: Getting Better at Prompting

The Prompt Improver

Here's a prompt I've been using: [paste it]. The results are [what's wrong – too vague, too long, missing the point, etc.]. Rewrite this prompt to get better results. Explain what you changed and why.

Why it works: Claude is excellent at improving prompts — the explanation teaches you the principles.

The Role Assigner

For the rest of this conversation, act as a [specific expert role] with [X] years of experience in [field]. I'm going to ask you about [topic]. Push back if my assumptions are wrong. Ask me clarifying questions before giving advice – don't guess at what I need.

Why it works: The 'push back' and 'ask me' instructions turn Claude from an agreeable assistant into a useful advisor.

The Output Reformatter

Take this content: [paste text]. Reformat it as [format: table, bullet points, numbered steps, FAQ, executive summary, email]. Keep all the substance – just change the shape. If anything is unclear in the original, flag it rather than guessing.

Why it works: The 'flag it rather than guessing' instruction prevents Claude from silently filling gaps.

The Conversation Starter

I want to explore [topic]. I don't know enough to ask good questions yet. Give me a 2-minute overview, then suggest 5 follow-up questions I could ask – ranging from basic to advanced. Don't assume I know anything about this.

Why it works: Perfect for when you don't know what you don't know — Claude maps the territory for you.

The Iteration Prompt

Your last response was [good/close/off]. Here's what worked: [specifics]. Here's what didn't: [specifics]. Try again with these adjustments: [what to change]. Keep [what to preserve].

Why it works: The most important prompt in this library. Iteration is where the real quality happens.

Building Your Own Prompt Library

These 30 prompts are a starting point. The best prompts are the ones you build yourself, tuned to your specific work. Here's how to grow your library:

Save what works. When a prompt gets great results, copy it to a document. Note what made it work.

Name your prompts. "The Monday Email Drafter" is easier to find than a paragraph of text.

Version them. When you improve a prompt, keep the old version. You'll see patterns in what makes prompts better.

Share them. The best prompt libraries are team resources, not personal secrets.

This library is a companion to [Creating with Claude: A Practical Guide for Everyone](#). Chapter 2 teaches prompt craft by building a real project. Chapter 10 helps you build a permanent prompt system. Get the book at marquepublishing.com.